Payson's Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Loredas, the 31st of Frostfall (Saturday, October 31, 2026) ·
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Gandy endures the rain under the eaves while Maevy bats at the raindrops.

Skies o'er the Hold 58° / 50° Rain

A wet, cool day — rain through the day, a steady breeze, and rain through the day.

Wind 9 mph · Feels like 57° · UV 5 (Moderate) · Rain 92%
Sunrise 6:44 AM · Sunset 5:33 PM · Tomorrow — Hard rain, 56/49

The Moon's Reckoning

Yesterday (Waning Gibbous) · Tonight (Last Quarter) · Tomorrow
waning toward the new moon

Morning	Noon	Late Afternoon	Evening
53° Overcast, 7 mph	56° Overcast, 7 mph	57° Overcast, 4 mph	55° Drizzle, 3 mph

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Rain, Lanterns, and Treats — Halloween Fills the Holds

Payson, Ariz.

Listen to this story

PAYSON — Hail, wayfarer, and mind the puddles on the road in! The rain has settled over the Rim for Halloween, high 58 and low 50 with a 92% chance of rain, and still the Holds are dressing up: lantern walks at Fort Verde, trunk-or-treat crowds in Camp Verde and Show Low, costumed crowds in Uptown Sedona, and a whole avenue of treats in Prescott. Closer to home, Payson starts the day with its Saturday Morning Cafe at 9:30. By the Nine, bring a cloak — it is a wet one, and a merry one.



Lanterns, treats, and a haunted fort — Halloween night across the Holds, rain and all.

Happening in the Holds Today

Listen to this story

- **Payson**
  — **Morning Cafe on Zoom — Saturdays at 9:30 AM**, at Unity of Payson, 110 E Bonita. A gentle, friendly start to the day: an inspirational Saturday morning gathering, in person and on Zoom, that runs to about 12:30 PM. A fine first stop before the rain and the Halloween crowds take over the Hold. New faces are welcome, and the welcome is warm. Bring your coffee and settle in.

- **Camp Verde**
  — **Trunk or Treat on Main Street**, 5:00–7:00 PM in downtown Camp Verde. Decorated cars and businesses line Main Street while families walk trunk to trunk for candy, with haunted houses, games, music, movies, and a Haunted Jail in the bargain. The town counts its crowd in the thousands of kids and parents in good years. Costumes are the whole point — come as your favorite hero or monster.

— **A Haunting at the Fort**, 6:00–8:00 PM at Fort Verde State Historic Park, 125 E. Hollamon St. A ghostly lantern-lit walk through the old fort after hours, with ghost stories and a visit with those who, the rangers say, still call the fort home after 150 years. There is no extra cost for the event; regular park admission applies. It runs alongside the town Trunk or Treat, so one trip serves both.

- **Sedona**

  — **Uptown Trick or Treat**, 5:00–8:00 PM in Uptown Sedona, 200 N. SR 89A. Participating merchants hand out candy while families in costume fill the Uptown corridor with Halloween fun. It is free and family friendly, and the red rocks make a fine backdrop for a parade of small ghosts. Arrive a little early — Uptown fills up fast on Halloween night.

- **Show Low**

  — **Show Low Main Street Halloween Trunk or Treat 2026**, from 3:00 PM on Main Street in downtown Show Low. Rows of decorated trunks, costumed kids, and candy by the bagful in the heart of town — the White Mountains way of doing Halloween up right. Families can make an early start here and still be home before the rain gets serious. Costumes encouraged for grown-ups too.

- **Prescott**

  — **Halloween on Mt. Vernon**, from 2:00 PM on Mt. Vernon Ave in the historic district, and it is free. The avenue closes for one of the most loved Halloween walks in Arizona: historic homes, big decorations, and treats handed out along the street. It is the kind of old-fashioned Halloween a bard would sing about. Go early in the afternoon to beat the thickest of the crowd.

  — **Frontier Dog & Co's Howl-O-Ween Hoedown**, from 10:00 AM in Prescott. A Halloween party where the dogs are the guests of honor — costumed hounds, happy chaos, and a morning crowd that takes pup pageantry very seriously. A grand warm-up for the evening's human festivities. Bring your four-legged companion in their finest monster dress.

The Days Ahead

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- **Sun, Nov. 1**

  — **Sedona Community Farmers Market**, 8:00 AM at 2201 W SR 89A, Sedona. Local growers, bakers, and makers set out their best on a Sunday morning — fresh produce, baked goods, and Rim Country flavor in every stall. A gentle way to walk off Halloween. Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for Rim Country air at markets like this one.

  — **Tierra Flamenca: Guitar, Dance, and Classical Roots**, 3:00 PM at Ruth Street Community Theater in Prescott, tickets $28–$69. Lena Jácome dances and Chris Jácome plays, with Arizona Philharmonic strings — heels striking the stage and guitar carrying the hall. A rich, warm afternoon of music after a wet weekend. Worth the drive over the hill.

- **Tue, Nov. 3**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build in Pine**, from 7:00 AM off Highway 87 just before Pine. Pine Strawberry Fuel Reduction invites hikers, bikers, runners, and neighbors to clear brush, move rocks, and shape trails that will serve the Hold for years — and give fire crews better access when it matters. Tools are provided; bring water, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes. To volunteer, email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions and details.

  — **Snakes! Lizards! Tortoises!**, 11:00 AM at 336 AZ-179, Sedona. A close-up morning with the desert's scaly neighbors — the kind of talk where the creatures are the teachers and every kid in the room leans in. Fine family fare for a school-day adventure. Come with questions; leave with respect for the wildlife under the Rim.

- **Fri, Nov. 6**

  — **Sedona Mountain Bike Festival** opens at 9:00 AM at Posse Grounds, 525 Posse Grounds Rd., Sedona. Three days of red-rock riding begin: demo bikes, group rides, and a festival crowd of riders from every Hold and beyond. Even non-riders will enjoy the spectacle and the food. The Rim's trails show off their best this weekend.

— **Small Works Show opening reception**, 4:00–7:00 PM at Mountain Trails Gallery in Tlaquepaque, Sedona. The gallery's popular Small Works show opens with new work by Arizona artist Greg Heil and others, plus animal artist Sarah Webber in attendance. Small pieces, big country — a fine First Friday evening among the galleries. The show runs through the holidays.

— **Anthony Mazzella — Legends of Guitar**, 7:00 PM at the Prescott Elks Theater. A night of guitar legends' music played by a master of the instrument, in one of the prettiest old theaters in the territory. A strong close to the week's doings. Seats in historic halls go fast — plan ahead.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The Hearth workshop: shield, sconces, and doors waiting on the bench.

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Measure the flame bulb and socket, then scale a wall-torch model to fit — the quest that starts them all. Due Sept. 26 — overdue.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Print two torches plus the socket test piece, and test-fit bulb and socket first. Due Oct. 3 — overdue.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Paint faux wrought iron or wood, UV seal, then wire the sockets with the breaker OFF. Due Oct. 10 — overdue.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Finalize the size for the door placement, then cut and engrave. Due Oct. 17 — overdue.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, placed for best sight from the walkway. Due Oct. 24 — overdue.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Front and side door work for the guest house. Due Oct. 24 — overdue.

Longest waiting on the board: the torch sconces — their design was due back on Friday, Sept. 26, and the torches still want lighting, by the Nine!

Merchant of the Hold

Listen to this story

Bill's Pizza · *Prescott*



The sourdough goes into the stone hearth — Bill's Pizza, Prescott.

A downtown Prescott institution on Cortez Street, right across from Courthouse Square and Whiskey Row, serving sourdough-crust pizzas with fresh toppings — by the whole pie or by the slice. The signature bite is that sourdough crust itself, with named pies like the Eastwood and Nonni's Pie leading the board; a touch of kitchen magic — call it a slow-rise enchantment — is what lets a crust come out crisp, chewy, and full of flavor every single time. Dine in or take out, lunch and dinner.

> *"Bills Pizza in Prescott is THE BEST EVER!! I love the sourdough crust they make for their pizza."* — TripAdvisor review

107 S Cortez St, Prescott, AZ 86303. Hours: Mon–Thu 11 AM–9 PM, Fri–Sat 11 AM–10 PM, Sun 12–9 PM. Phone (928) 443-0800. Price: moderate. Good to know: happy hour runs all day Mondays and Saturday nights 8–10, and the room fills fast after shows at the Elks Theater. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Because a guest who has walked Whiskey Row deserves the best slice in the Hold — and this is the pie the locals themselves swear by.

Tales from the Treeline

Listen to this story

The Great Apple-Bobbing Upset



Earl wins Most Apples Moved at Once — Henny's ruling stands.

Loredas dawned wet over the Hearth, so Mabel (a wood elf) moved the Halloween apple-bobbing barrel under the porch roof and declared fair rules: no hands, no antlers, no magic. Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) went first and came up grinning with an apple in each cheek, looking for all the world like a squirrel with secrets.

Then came Earl (an elk). Earl lowered his great dignified head, caught the barrel's rim squarely between his antlers, and lifted the whole barrel clean off the porch boards, apples, water, and all. Rain and barrel-water poured down together while Earl stood blinking, wearing a barrel like a very surprised hat.

Henny (the Hearth's chicken), judging from the barrel's edge, gave one flat cluck — the official ruling. Mabel sighed the sigh of a wood elf who has seen this exact thing before, set the barrel back down, and awarded Earl the prize for Most Apples Moved at Once. That dang ol' Jethro is still claiming he won on style.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Loredas be free of dragons, the admin.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com

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STOLEN SWEETROLL?

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